

Per-Platform Playbook

Reddit is nearly half of Perplexity's citations and under 10% of ChatGPT's. The platforms are not interchangeable.

Bottom line

Each engine retrieves from a different place. ChatGPT leans on Bing plus Wikipedia and pulls **90% of citations from pages ranked 21+** on Google. Perplexity is community-heavy and recency-obsessed. Gemini favors Google properties. Claude favors long-form definitive sources. Optimizing generically for "AI" wastes effort on whichever platform your buyers actually use.

The four engines

Platform	Retrieval behavior
ChatGPT	Bing-indexed content plus Wikipedia (47.9% of referrals). About 90% of citations come from pages ranked 21+ on Google
Perplexity	Real-time search, community-heavy. Reddit is nearly half its top citations versus under 10% for ChatGPT. Strongest recency bias, content over 90 days loses priority
Gemini	~ 43% from Google properties, 21% Reddit . Deep Workspace integration
Claude	Reasoning-first, 200,000+ token context. Favors long-form definitive guides and academic-style signals

[practitioner]

ChatGPT

The most surprising number in this section: roughly 90% of ChatGPT citations come from pages ranked 21 or below on Google. [practitioner]

That is not a typo and it is worth sitting with. The pages ChatGPT quotes are overwhelmingly not the pages Google ranks first. If you have been treating Google rank as a proxy for AI visibility, this is the number that breaks it.

What it retrieves from:

- **Bing's index**, not Google's. If you are not in Bing, you effectively do not exist here.
- **Wikipedia**, at **47.9% of referrals**, which is an enormous single-source share.

What to do:

- 1 **Verify Bing Webmaster Tools is set up and your site is indexed.** Most SEOs never check this. It takes ten minutes and it is a hard prerequisite for the largest AI platform.
- 2 **Submit your sitemap to Bing** as well as Google.
- 3 **Build Wikipedia and Wikidata presence** where you legitimately qualify. Section 40.
- 4 **Do not assume Google rankings carry over.** They mostly do not.

The Bing check is the highest-value ten minutes in this section and almost nobody does it.

Perplexity

Two defining characteristics: community sources and aggressive recency.

Reddit is nearly half of Perplexity's top citations. Under 10% for ChatGPT. If your category is discussed on Reddit, Perplexity is reading those threads.

Content over 90 days loses priority. The strongest recency bias of any platform.
[practitioner]

What to do:

- 1 **Refresh content that matters to you every quarter**, per Section 19. This is where the freshness argument has the sharpest platform-specific payoff.
- 2 **Keep dateModified accurate**, per Section 30. Faking it is still a bad idea.
- 3 **Participate genuinely in the communities where your category is discussed.** Genuinely is load-bearing. Reddit detects and punishes marketing, and a banned account is worse than absence.
- 4 **Publish timely content** where you have a real point of view on something current.

Perplexity is also the platform where the honest answer to "should we be on Reddit" is most often yes, and where the honest answer to "should we post promotional threads on Reddit" is firmly no.

Gemini

~43% Google properties, 21% Reddit. [practitioner]

The most conventional of the four from an SEO perspective. Classic Google SEO carries over here better than anywhere else, and the Reddit share means the community argument applies too.

The Workspace integration is the strategic difference: Gemini sits inside Docs, Gmail and Sheets, which means it answers questions in a work context rather than a search context. For B2B, that is

where a buyer is actually working.

What to do: keep doing good Google SEO, and treat the Reddit share as a second reason to take communities seriously.

Claude

Reasoning-first, 200,000+ token context, favors long-form definitive guides and academic-style signals. [practitioner]

The large context window is the mechanism. Claude can hold and reason over entire long documents rather than needing short extractable chunks, which changes what wins: comprehensive, well-argued, well-cited long-form content rather than snippet-optimized pages.

What to do:

- 1 **Write the definitive guide** on the topics you want to own. Depth genuinely wins here.
- 2 **Cite sources thoroughly**, per Section 37. Academic-style signals are explicitly favored.
- 3 **Do not fragment a topic into ten thin pages** for keyword coverage. That works against you on this platform.

Note this pulls slightly against the 134 to 167 word answer-unit advice from Sections 36 and

- 1 Both are true: structure content into standalone units *within* comprehensive long-form pieces. Good structure inside genuine depth serves every platform.

Reading this as a strategy

Do not optimize for all four equally. Find out which your buyers use.

For most B2B service businesses the practical ordering is ChatGPT first on raw volume, then Perplexity for research-heavy categories, then Gemini for Workspace-native organizations, then Claude for technical and developer audiences.

The cross-platform actions that pay everywhere:

- Be indexed in Bing, not just Google
- Build Wikidata presence and entity clarity (Section 40)
- Maintain genuine community presence where your category is discussed
- Refresh important content quarterly
- Write comprehensively, structured into standalone units
- Build consistent brand mentions across platforms (Section 34)

Every one of those helps on at least two engines. Anything platform-specific beyond this list should follow evidence that your buyers are on that platform.

Why this matters

the single fact that ChatGPT draws about 90% of its citations from pages ranked 21+ dismantles the assumption that AI visibility is a byproduct of Google ranking. Different index, different selection, different winners. Checking Bing indexation is a ten-minute task that most SEO audits skip entirely.

Do this now

- 1 **Write 10 questions a real buyer would ask** before hiring you. Full sentences, not keywords.
- 2 **Ask all four platforms the same 10 questions.** ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, Claude.
- 3 **Log every cited source in a sheet**, one row per question per platform.
- 4 **Count how often you are cited on each platform.** That is your citation share baseline.
- 5 **Note who is cited instead of you** and what those pages have that yours do not.
- 6 **Check Bing Webmaster Tools.** Is your site indexed? If you do not have an account, create one and submit your sitemap today.
- 7 **Search Reddit for your category** and note whether real discussion exists. If it does, Perplexity and Gemini are reading it.
- 8 **Check the dates on your most important pages.** Anything over 90 days is deprioritized by Perplexity.
- 9 **Pick the one platform your buyers most plausibly use** and note the specific action from its section above.

Capstone step

Your capstone has a citation share baseline across all four platforms on 10 real buyer questions, a list of who is cited instead of you, confirmed Bing indexation, an assessment of community presence in your category, and one platform prioritized with a specific action.

Key takeaways

- **~90% of ChatGPT citations come from pages ranked 21+** on Google, and it retrieves from Bing plus Wikipedia. Check Bing indexation, it takes ten minutes and almost nobody does.
- Perplexity is **nearly half Reddit** and deprioritizes content over **90 days**. Community presence and quarterly refresh are the levers.
- Gemini is the most conventional (**~43% Google properties**), Claude favors long-form definitive guides with academic-style citation.
- Optimize for the platform your buyers use, and do the cross-platform basics: Bing indexation, entity clarity, real community presence, quarterly refresh, comprehensive well-structured writing.